



SIGNAL

FALL 2025 ISSUE



Vern Eide
— EMPLOYEE OWNED —

Our Vision: To enhance the lives of our employees, customers, and the community
Our Mission: We Deliver Dreams



PRESENTING THE SIGNAL'S ALL NEW **FEATURED VEHICLE**

Article and Photos by Tristan Lake

Doug Lake's 1964 Ford Thunderbird

Few silhouettes on the road turn heads quite like the 1964 Ford Thunderbird. Its sweeping lines and confident stance are matched by the power beneath the hood: a 390 cubic-inch V8 producing 300 horsepower and plenty of torque. This is a car that was built not just for getting somewhere; but for arriving in style.

My grandpa, and Jim Lakes brother, Doug Lake, purchased this Thunderbird in the mid-'90s and has cared for it ever since, preserving a piece of automotive history. Now, I get the chance to tell its story through The Signal. The goal is to bring many more stories like this one to life and to celebrate the vehicles that mean something to the people who drive them - you! Every Vern Eide employee has the opportunity to share their own ride, whether it's on four wheels or two, land or water, new or old, as every unique vehicle deserves to be celebrated.

Our goal is to feature one special vehicle from our Vern Eide family per issue, showcased on the cover and in a full-spread article that shares its unique history.

How It Works

Want to see your own pride and joy in print? Just scan the QR code below and fill out the form to submit your ride for consideration.



Employees may upload their own photos while submitting. Afterward, we will connect with the owner, arrange a photo session, and bring the story of the vehicle to life on the page.

Because every ride has a story, and here in the Signal, every employee has a chance to share theirs.

Email tlake@verneide.com for any ?'s



**Let us
know
about your
ride for a
possible
future issue
of the
Signal!**



Vern Eide Golfers Give Back to the McCue Family

With leadership and organization from our own Randy Finch (Sales Consultant for Vern Eide Marine and some car deals too!), the annual Vern Eide golf fundraiser donated all proceeds to the McCue family in honor of long-time employee Bonnie McCue, who passed away from cancer, in July. It was a beautiful September Sunday to celebrate Bonnie's many contributions to the Vern Eide staff over the years. Thank you all for the generous support of the McCue family.



Jim Lake, The McCue Family, and Randy Finch



You can find it wherever great podcasts are streamed or subscribe directly to your email at adamweber.com/theconversation

Eide Effect Heroes September 2025



Austin Kerr

Accountant

Vern Eide
EMPLOYEE OWNED

"Austin fits right in with the team- easy to talk to, fun to work with, and always ready to help out. His great smile and upbeat energy make the workplace better for everyone around him."

Nominated by Jackson Lake Vern Eide Marine



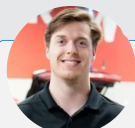
Eli VandenBosch

Service Advisor

Vern Eide
Acura

"His dedication to customer service and willingness to go the extra mile truly embody the Eide Effect. Thank you, Eric, for all that you do — your hard work does not go unnoticed!"

Nominated by Gilberto Salazar/Vern Eide Mitsubishi



Bryce Huitt

Parts Advisor

Vern Eide
Mitsubishi

"Hunter is a very passionate sales rep who has taken his young career very seriously. He is absolutely amazing with his customers and understands the whole process front and back."

Nominated by Susan Trauman Vern Eide Honda



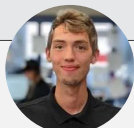
Steve Eggebraaten

Sales Manager

Vern Eide
Honda

"Steve is one of the best human beings I have ever worked with. He lives by a genuine code that we all strive for. He has a very real connection with everyone he knows. This is because Steve cares deeply about everyone's well-being and success."

Nominated by Bryan Thu Vern Eide Honda



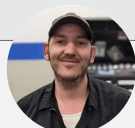
Ethan Feyereisen

Service Advisor

Vern Eide
MOTO PLEX

"He does countless things to deserve this reward. I think he deserves this recognition because he works very hard, is always willing to help other people, and always wants to figure out what he can do to be better at his job."

Nominated by Taj Rieck Vern Eide Motoplex



Devin Paulsen

Service Technician

Vern Eide
POWERHOUSE

"Talk about the unsung hero. He is a leader, teacher, and always willing to help when he can. When I think of Devin, I think of humble. The man is one of the Nation's leading technicians, "with the hardware to back it," and 95% of people would never know it!"

Nominated by Ethan Sorenson Vern Eide Powerhouse

Vern Eide
Acura

Vern Eide
BODY SHOP

Vern Eide
Honda

Vern Eide
Mitsubishi

Vern Eide Celebrates Growth & Opportunity

Shareholders Meeting

Over 220 staffers from Acura, Honda, Mitsubishi, Marine, Rentals, IT, and VVI gathered on October 2nd at Embrace Church in Tea for the annual meeting of employee-owner shareholders in the Vern Eide Motorcars Employee Stock Ownership Plan.



Jim Lake reflects on the power of One More

Shareholders and soon-to-be shareholders heard about the continued growth of our share accounts, the importance of continued training & self-improvement, and a message from Jim Lake about adding \$4.5 million in profit for the employee-owners in 2026, with the challenge of "One more car a week!" and how we can all play a part in that goal.

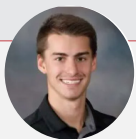
60th Celebration

The week after, employees gathered again for Vern Eide's 60th Anniversary Celebration, noting the company's start on October 13, 1965, when Vern himself took over the Buick Opel dealership from previous owner Paul McKean.



Music from Good Road set the tone for Vern Eide's 60th Anniversary Celebration

Eide Effect Heroes October 2025



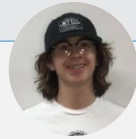
Jordan Dirkes

Business Manager

Vern Eide
Mitsubishi

"His professionalism, attention to detail, and genuine care for both coworkers and customers are evident in everything he does. Jordan not only excels in his role but also creates a positive environment by caring about the people around him."

**Nominated by Austin Kerr
Vern Eide**



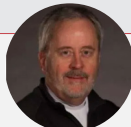
Noah Eggebraaten

Service and
Car Wash Attendant

Vern Eide
Honda

"When Noah started with us a few years back, he was a shy reserved kid. Now I walk through the service drive and see a young man who likes helping people. He greets them in a way that makes them feel special."

**Nominated by Steve Eggebraaten
Vern Eide Honda**



John Ulmer

Chief Financial Officer

Vern Eide
EMPLOYEE OWNED

"Although I have not worked with Ulmer side by side, I know that when I leave work and I see his office lights on way past working hours, the financial health of Vern Eide will continue, and I can sleep well at night."

**Nominated by Eric Nelson
Vern Eide Leasing**



Josh Hepler

Accelerated Technician

Vern Eide
Acura

"Josh is always willing to be a helper to anyone in the dealership who needs some assistance. From 'fixing' the car wash to helping clean up the shop or assisting main shop techs with tasks, with Josh... no is not an answer."

Nominated by Eli VandenBosch/Vern Eide Acura



Jesse Olson

Warehouse Lead

Vern Eide
MOTO V PLEX

"Jesse is always willing to work hard with a great attitude. Even under stressful conditions, Jesse is always willing to go the extra mile to make sure everyone is being taken care of. He is great at communicating with everyone, which is also very helpful."

Nominated by Ethan Feyereisen/Vern Eide Motoplex



Emily Swanger

Service Consultant

Vern Eide
Honda

"She is always very, very helpful when I need anything done or can point me in the right direction. She also strives to be better and beat her own records she is setting for herself."

**Nominated by Hunter Otten
Vern Eide Honda**



Joe Nelson

Service Technician

Vern Eide
Mitsubishi

"Joe has turned into a great leader for the service department. No matter how busy he is, the Mitsu Master makes time to answer any questions we have. He puts in effort and attention to detail to every car he works on."

**Nominated by Bryce Huitt
Vern Eide Mitsubishi**



Leah Hofer

Apparel Consultant

Vern Eide
POWER HOUSE

"She deserves it because she always has a smile and a good attitude, always just jumps in and does what needs to be taken care of, regardless of whether or not it's her job to take care of. We need more of that can-do attitude. Thanks, Leah, for making a difference!"

**Nominated by Devin Paulsen
Vern Eide Powerhouse**

*Nomination text has been shortened for the newsletter. Full versions are available in the corporate email and breakroom printouts.





Our Reason Why: To improve the quality of life for our employees, our customers, and our community.

Because you choose to show up every day and do what you do with excellence, we're able to give to non-profit organizations and missions that exist to serve the greater good of our community.

August Donations

St. Francis House - Cash donation to support their ministry providing transitional housing for single men and women, as well as families with children. They focus on assisting with obtaining employment, teaching financial literacy, counseling for alcohol and drug addictions, and building family relationships

Kingdom Capital Fund - Auction items to support their mission of spreading the word of God to others

Sioux Valley Optimist Club - Cash donation to support underserved youth in our area

Lost & Found - Cash donation to support their mission of preventing suicide and promoting mental health among young adults

STAR Heroes - Cash donation to support care packages and cards to send to deployed military

Harrisburg Band Boosters - Cash donation to be used to purchase additional sheet music, provide unique educational and instructional experiences, and offset the expenses of travel for competitions

Roosevelt Band BPA - Cash donation to support their fundraising to purchase new drum equipment, travel expenses, and student scholarships

South Dakota Arthritis Foundation - Cash donation to raise awareness, support youth living with arthritis, and fund research toward a cure.

Rock Ranch - Cash donation providing therapeutic opportunities for people to improve themselves physically, cognitively, socially, and emotionally through horsemanship in a Christ-centered setting

Dakotathon at USD - Cash donation to support their student-led dance marathon event raising funds for the Children's Miracle Network

Crooks Community Childcare Center - Auction item supporting their Halloween carnival for the whole community

September Donations

Garfield Elementary - Cash donation toward prize incentives to encourage student attendance

Skills USA - Cash donation to support and educate high school students about the skilled workforce

Westside Christian School - Cash donation to support their largest fundraiser of the year, raising funds for students paying reduced tuition, essential expenses like paying staff, and keeping the doors open.

Veterans Community Project - Honor Hike - Cash donation toward the mission to end Veteran homelessness

Parent Advocations for Spanish Immersion - Auction donation to support the intern program, bringing in Spanish-speaking interns from around the world to integrate into the classrooms for better learning experiences for the students.

Teacher Support - Cash donation to support the purchase of books and a reading nook in a classroom at Whittier Middle School to encourage students to spend more time reading, providing better outcomes and success for these students in adult life

Crooks Fire Department - Auction donation to support raising funds for new equipment and ongoing training

Bryan Boys For Hope - Cash donation to go toward the manufacturing of a brand new medicine that will help cure Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy

Mosaic Halloween Party - Candy donation for trunk or treat

The Forty & Eight - Cash donation to support their purpose to promote the well-being of veterans, along with their widows and orphans.

Compass Center - Cash donation to support the mission of navigating the journey to healing for all affected by sexual, relational, and family trauma.

Veterans Final Tribute - Cash donation to support the mission of giving Veterans a proper and respectful burial when their families are unable to afford it themselves

Active Generations - Cash donation to support the additional building on the east side, promoting active fitness to the elderly generation

October Donations

Community Campus - Candy donation to support Trunk or Treat, where Community Campus students will give out candy to children who stop in. Community Campus is an educational program through the Sioux Falls School District for students ages 18-21 who have mild disabilities.

Roosevelt Show Choir - monetary donations supporting the show choir expenses, including choreography, music arrangements, costumes, sets, etc.

Fight Like A Ninja - fundraising hockey tournament focused on adolescent girls to raise awareness and offer a safe space to talk about mental health and suicide prevention.

Sioux Falls Christian Schools - items donated to the annual auction raised funds to help with scholarships for families that cannot afford the tuition, but prefer a Christian education.

New Haven Ministries - Cash donation in support of this organization, whose mission is to offer biblical counseling at no charge to kids, most coming off the streets.

HeARTS in Healing - Cash donation in support of raising funds that go to outpatient and inpatient child and adolescent patients each year. Specialized programs, including addiction, urgent care, and partial hospitalizations for behavioral health.

St Katharine Drexel Parish - item donation supporting the Parish Food and Diaper Pantry

Marine Corps League - item donation for an auction supporting community organizations like school lunch programs, Honor Flights, and more.

Avera Behavioral Health - item donation for raffle raising funds supporting behavioral health missions in our community.

Lutheran Social Services of South Dakota - Cash donation contributing to their services offered, including adoption, foster care, financial counseling, English language and job skill training to refugees, and more.

Evermore Blooms - Cash donation benefiting the community of support to those grieving the loss of a baby to miscarriage

Hundreds of Kids Attend Annual Trunk or Treat

Vern Eide Marine & Mitsubishi hosted our annual Halloween "Trunk or Treat" tradition on October 23rd, drawing hundreds of kids from the neighborhood and community. We provide the vehicles/trunks and candy, and various non-profits & community organizations provide the decorating - including a few of our own departments from around the Arrowhead location.



A few of the friendly faces that assisted and participated in our Trunk or Treat!

Vern Elde JUMBLED

The Scrambled Word Downtime Killer!

The letters of these crazy words are all mixed up. Unscramble them to make real words you can find at Vern Elde. Write one letter per square. The circled letters will help you solve the final phrase!

RAC

OTBA

ELAS

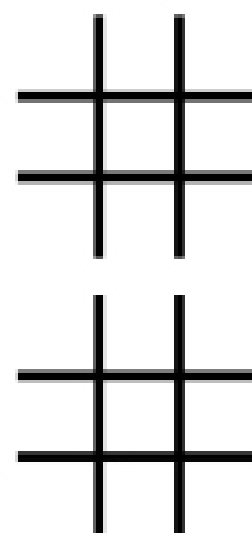
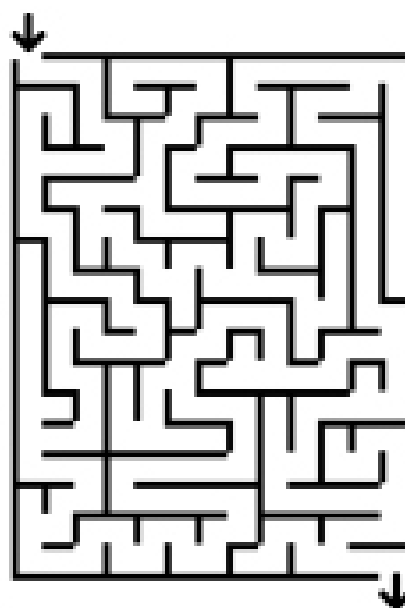
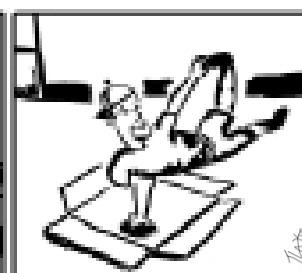
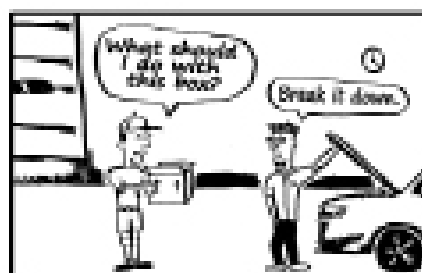


Put Answer Here:

11

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12



CROSSWORD

Across

2. Group of notes played together in music
7. Automaker of Accord and Civic
9. "Back to the Future" time machine car
10. Tribe that gave us a word for destruction
12. Harp-like instrument of ancient Greece and Rome

Down

1. Ancient empire's capital city
3. Dance style tied to Saturday Night Fever
4. Ford car brand, or Queen's famous frontman
5. John, Paul, George, and Ringo's band
6. Six-stringed rock instrument
8. Largest member of the brass family
10. Records prized by collectors
11. Venue for gladiators or concerts

